

PITCHBIRD · FOUNDER GUIDE



The Power of the One Pager

Capturing your startup in a single, investor-ready snapshot

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01 · WHY IT MATTERS

One sheet of paper. One decision.

The one-pager is the door, not the room. Done well, it earns you the meeting. Done badly, it earns you silence — and you'll never know which line lost you the deal.

A pitch deck wins the room. The one-pager wins the chance to be in the room. It travels in inboxes, sits on phone screens, and gets forwarded between partners — usually without you in the conversation.

That means every element has to do double duty: **introduce, intrigue, and stand on its own**. No verbal context. No follow-up slide. Just the page.

Founders consistently overspend on design polish and underspend on the boring essentials — including, embarrassingly often, their own contact details.

32%

of decision-makers drop off after 15 seconds of reading a one-pager. The first impression is the only impression.

SOURCE · STORYDOC, 2024



Treat the one-pager as the most-circulated document you will ever make. Because it is.

02 · THE FRAMEWORK

The eight non-negotiables

If a one-pager misses any of these, it is incomplete. Treat this as the checklist before you send anything.

01

Company name & logo

Identity is the anchor. Make sure investors know who they're dealing with before they read a single word.

02

Contact information

The most-skipped basic. If they can't reach you in one click, the deck did nothing.

03

Company profile

A short, informative introduction — what you are, who you serve, why you exist.

04

Business idea

Describe the core concept in one tight sentence. No jargon, no hedging.

05

Unique selling proposition

What makes this venture distinct from the next ten emails in the inbox.

06

Roadmap & timeline

Graphically show where the business is going and when. Visual beats prose here.

07

Investment ask

The amount needed, the structure (one-time or tranches), and the deadline. Specific.

08

Investment highlights

The three or four reasons this allocation pays back. Punchy, not vague.

03 · BEYOND THE BASICS

Add these if you have the space

The four below are the most common upgrades. None of them earn the page on their own; together they turn a competent one-pager into a memorable one.

NICE TO HAVE

Problem

The pain in market terms — frame it before you frame yourself.

NICE TO HAVE

Solution

How your business removes that pain. Two lines, max.

NICE TO HAVE

Traction

Proof customers want it. Revenue, signups, LOIs — whichever you have.

NICE TO HAVE

Target group & market

Who you're selling to, and the competitive landscape they live in.

04 · DESIGN PRINCIPLES

How investors actually read it

**Content is king**

Clarity first. Strong narrative — problem, solution, impact. Hierarchy via headings, sub-heads, and bullets that guide the eye.

**Visually appealing**

Clean composition, generous white space, strategic visuals over walls of text. Colour evokes brand, not chaos.

**Remember your audience**

Investors scan, not read. Lead with what helps their decision. Professional, confident tone throughout.

**Call to action**

End with one specific ask. 'Schedule a 20-minute call.' Not 'we'd love to chat sometime.'

05 · TRADE-OFFS

What the one-pager gives you — and what it can't

STRENGTHS

Respects the investor's time — and signals you respect it too.

Forces sharper thinking. If it doesn't fit on a page, the idea isn't focused yet.

Travels well — easy to forward, easy to print, easy to remember.

LIMITATIONS

Brevity is unforgiving. Every missing detail is a potential rejection.

Hard to write alone — outside eyes catch what founder-bias hides.

Not a substitute for the full deck. It is the door, not the room.

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The one-pager is brutal in the right way. If your business doesn't fit on the page, the business isn't sharp yet.

Want a Pitchbird review of your one-pager?

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